

# Progressive Discovery Engine v1

## Product Philosophy & Implementation Guide

Before making any changes, understand the purpose of this system.

Vocari is **not** a personality assessment.

It is **not** a career quiz.

It is **not** trying to produce one perfect answer after 20 minutes.

Vocari is built on one core belief:

**Self-understanding is a process, not an event.**

The current application promises this throughout the homepage.

We tell users:

- Your profile grows with you.
- Recommendations improve over time.
- Every reflection sharpens the picture.
- Profile DNA evolves.

Unfortunately, the current prototype does not actually behave this way.

Today the experience is still largely static.

A user can add multiple reflections and nothing changes.

This creates a disconnect between the product promise and the product experience.

The goal of this build is to make that promise real.

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## New Product Philosophy

Think of Vocari less as an assessment and more as an ongoing conversation.

The user is never "finished."

Every meaningful interaction should teach Vocari something new.

Every meaningful interaction should return something valuable to the user.

If a user spends another minute helping Vocari understand them, they should immediately receive something in return.

This exchange is the foundation of trust.

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## Rename the Concept Internally

Do not think of this as "Adaptive Onboarding."

Think of it as the **Progressive Discovery Engine**.

Onboarding is only the first place users experience it.

Eventually this same engine will power:

- Reflection prompts
- Whiteboard exercises
- Weekly check-ins
- Career exploration
- Profile edits
- Future AI conversations

This is the learning engine behind the entire platform.

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## The Experience

The current Start Here assessment should no longer have a true ending.

Instead it becomes Stage One of a continuing conversation.

After the initial assessment is complete, Vocari should begin offering short Discovery Sessions.

Each session contains only two to four prompts.

These are never overwhelming.

They are always optional.

They are always personalized.

The experience should feel like:

"I already know a little about you. Let me ask one better question."

Not:

"Please complete another survey."

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## Discovery Sessions

Instead of saying:

Answer more questions

Present them as:

Discovery Session #6

Approximately 2 minutes

3 personalized prompts

Each session should explain exactly why it matters.

Example:

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Next Discovery Session

We'd like to better understand how you solve problems.

Estimated time:

45 seconds

Completing this session will help:

✓ Improve leadership insights

✓ Strengthen Profile DNA

✓ Increase recommendation confidence

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The user should always understand the return on their investment.

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# Progressive Understanding

Avoid presenting a score called "Confidence."

People naturally interpret percentages as grades.

Seeing

Understanding: 61%

often feels like failure.

Instead, surface progress as understanding.

Examples:

Profile Understanding

Discovery Progress

Understanding Your Story

This should communicate growth rather than evaluation.

Instead of:

Confidence: 64%

Consider something like:

Profile Understanding

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We're beginning to recognize how you approach complex problems.

We'd love to learn more about how you make important decisions.

The goal is encouragement.

Not scoring.

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## Recommendations Should Feel Stable

One of Vocari's biggest differentiators is trust.

Recommendations should not constantly reshuffle.

Small answers should produce small changes.

Large insights should produce meaningful changes.

If Product Designer moves above Data Analyst after one small reflection, users will lose trust.

Instead:

Recommendations remain stable.

Confidence increases.

Explanations deepen.

Evidence grows.

Occasionally a recommendation changes.

When it does, explain why.

Never silently reorder careers.

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Instead of:

Product Designer moved from #3 to #1.

Present:

Since your last Discovery Session we became much more confident about:

✓ Systems Thinking

✓ Curiosity

✓ Teaching

These changes strengthened your fit for:

↑ Product Designer

↑ UX Researcher

Users should feel they are growing.

Not that the algorithm is changing its mind.

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## Contradictions Are Valuable

People change.

Priorities change.

Life changes.

Contradictory answers should never be treated as errors.

Instead they represent learning.

Avoid messaging such as:

Confidence decreased.

Instead communicate:

We've learned something new.

or

Your recent experiences point in a different direction.

or

Your priorities appear to be evolving.

Vocari should embrace growth instead of pretending people stay consistent forever.

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## Achievement Through Recognition

Avoid traditional gamification.

No badges for answering questions.

Instead celebrate understanding.

Examples:

Systems Thinking confirmed.

We've now seen this pattern across six different experiences.

or

New insight unlocked.

You're consistently energized by improving existing systems.

These moments reinforce that Profile DNA is becoming more accurate.

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## Adaptive Question Engine

The question engine should actively identify weak evidence areas.

Example:

We know a lot about:

✓ Interests

✓ Strengths

✓ Values

We know very little about:

- Preferred work environment
- Leadership style
- Decision making

Future prompts should naturally fill those gaps.

Questions should reference previous answers whenever appropriate.

Example:

Earlier you mentioned enjoying photography.

What part do you enjoy most?

Creating something beautiful?

Learning technical skills?

Capturing meaningful moments?

The user should feel Vocari remembers previous conversations.

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## Every Interaction Should Matter

The Progressive Discovery Engine should eventually learn from more than assessment answers.

Future signals should include:

Reflection Journal

Whiteboard exercises

Career pages viewed

Time spent exploring industries

Saved careers

Favorite recommendations

Career comparisons

Completed learning resources

None of these should drastically change Profile DNA individually.

Together they gradually improve understanding.

The user should feel that simply using Vocari teaches it something.

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## Relationship Between Features

Do not think of these as separate systems.

They are all inputs into the same engine.

Assessment

↓

Discovery Sessions

↓

Reflection Journal

↓

Whiteboard

↓

Career Exploration

↓

Saved Careers

↓

Profile DNA evolves

↓

Recommendations improve

↓

Career Roadmap becomes more personalized

Everything feeds the same understanding of the user.

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## Guiding Principle

Every meaningful interaction should make Vocari understand the user a little better.

Every contribution the user makes should return something of greater value in exchange.

If this principle is followed consistently, Vocari will naturally feel different from traditional career assessments because users will experience continuous self-discovery instead of receiving a static report once and never returning.